

Chicken Tikka Masala (Variation 6)

Tags: *chicken, indian, dinner, curry* | Prep: 25 min | Cook: 40 min | Serves: 10

Ingredients

- Tikka: 1750 g boneless chicken breast, 200 ml yoghurt, 2 tbsp lemon juice, 1 tsp each: cumin, coriander, turmeric, garam masala, 1/2 tsp chilli powder, 1 tsp salt
- Masala sauce: 7.5 tbsp ghee or butter, 1 large onion, 5 garlic cloves, 2 tsp ginger, 2 tsp cumin, 2 tsp coriander, 1 tsp turmeric, 1.5 tsp garam masala, 1 can (400 g) crushed tomatoes, 200 ml heavy cream, 1 tsp sugar, Salt
- naan or basmati rice, fresh dill to serve

Method

1. Cut chicken into 4 cm chunks. Combine with yoghurt and tikka spices. Marinate 1–8 hours.
2. Thread chicken onto skewers and cook under a very hot grill or in a cast-iron pan over high heat for 4–5 minutes per side until charred. Reserve.
3. For masala: Melt ghee over medium heat. Add onion and cook 8 minutes until very soft and golden.
4. Add garlic and ginger; cook 2 minutes. Add all dry spices, stir for 1 minute.
5. Add crushed tomatoes. Simmer 15 minutes until sauce is thick and oil separates.
6. Blend sauce smooth. Return to heat, add cream, sugar, and salt.
7. Add cooked chicken tikka pieces. Simmer gently for 10 minutes.
8. Serve with naan or rice, scattered with fresh cilantro.

Chef Tips

- The char on the tikka pieces is not optional — it is what distinguishes this dish from butter chicken.
- Bloom the spices in the fat before adding wet ingredients — this is the foundation of Indian cooking.
- Tikka Masala freezes beautifully for up to 3 months.